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(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title: COLORS, MOTIONS AND EMOTIONS: A JOURNEY INTO THE SOULS OF FESTIVAL DANCES IN THE PROVINCE OF CAPIZ	
Proponent Name:	RODYARD B. MADICLUM
Academic Rank:	ASSOCIATE PROFESOR V
Co-Authors (with academic rank):	
Campus/Satellite College/Address:	CAPIZ STATE UNIVERSITY BURIAS CAMPUS
Telephone/Cell Phone/Fax Number:	09193193920
E-mail Address:	rbmadiclum@capsu.edu.ph

Program or Project has component (if no proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Component Title:	
Component Leader:	
Academic Rank:	

(2) Category (please check) ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields ☐ Natural/BiologicalSciences ☐ Food Research/ ☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture ☐ Extension ☐ Poster	(3) Research Center [Check the concerned center] ☒ SSITRDC Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center ☐ LRDC Livestock Research Development Center ☐ FFRDC Fisheries and Food Research Development Center ☐ CSRDC Crop Science Research Development Center
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(4) Site of implementation							
Municipality/City:							
Province:	Capiz						
Region:	VI						
(5) Classification <table> <tr> <td>Research:</td> <td>Development:</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☒ Basic</td> <td>☐ Pilot Testing</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☐ Applied</td> <td>☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization</td> </tr> </table>	Research:	Development:	☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing	☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization	(6) Mode of Implementation ☒ Single Authorship/Proponent ☐ Collaborative Research (within campus) ☐ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)
Research:	Development:						
☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing						
☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization						
(7) Sector/Commodity	(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization Physical Education						

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(9A) Abstract (This has a maximum of 250 words. It contains 1-2 sentences of rationale, followed by objectives, brief methodology, major findings, and implications of impact of the study.)

This study delves into the significance of festival dances in the province of Capiz, focusing specifically on the history of practice, processes involved, procedures, beliefs, associated settings, social functions, and cultural meanings of these dances. It also addresses the challenges and issues encountered by locals, as well as the safeguarding measures taken to preserve and conserve these festival dances within their municipality. The rationale behind this research is to explore how these festival dances reflect and shape the cultural and social fabric of Capiz, providing insights into their multifaceted roles within the community. Corroborated of primary and secondary data approach, the research reviews existing literature and documentation on the topic, analyzing various sources to synthesize a comprehensive understanding of these festivals. The methodology involves a systematic review of relevant literature, including historical accounts, cultural analyses, and socio-economic studies related to festival dances in Capiz. This approach allows for a thorough examination of the dances' roles and impacts from multiple perspectives. The major findings reveal that festival dances in Capiz are integral to preserving cultural heritage, fostering community cohesion, and influencing socio-economic activities. These dances serve not only as artistic expressions but also as pivotal elements in local identity and tradition. The implications of these findings highlight the importance of supporting and sustaining these cultural practices, as they contribute significantly to the province's social and economic vitality.

(9B) Keywords (Write 3-6 words you used in the study, preferably not found in the title because words in the title are already given keywords. This would also include process, or methodology employed.)

Traditions, Cultural Significance, and Cultural Preservation

(10) Introduction (This includes the rationale, background of the study, and objectives which are not divided by subheadings. Incorporate at least three (3) reviews)

Festivals have historical roots that often extend back centuries, grounded in religious, agricultural, or historical events. These celebrations offer a window into the past, revealing how communities have evolved while maintaining a connection to their heritage (Getz, 2010).

Celebrations like the festivals are held to provide a hiatus from the daily tedious living, especially in rural areas (Chandervanshi, 2015). They provide opportunities for families to come together and reconnect with their roots (Selberg, 2006). Thus, festivals are ways of showing off the skills and talents of the people in the community, presenting the way of life, traditions, and products that identify the particular area. Most of all, it has become a socio-economic strategy for the locality to gain popularity in other places, locally if not internationally (Adriano, 2019).

The rationale behind this research is to explore how these festival dances reflect and shape the cultural and social fabric of Capiz, providing insights into their multifaceted roles within the community. Employing a primary and secondary data approach, the research reviews existing literature and documentation on the topic, analyzing various sources to synthesize a comprehensive understanding of these festivals.

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Festivals are the celebrations such as dance, drama, comedy, movie, music, variable arts, crafts, ethnic or local cultural heritage, religious traditions, historically important events, food and wine and religious ceremonies. The original appeal of the festivals comes from the fact that they are out of the ordinary life far from celebration and entertainment media. The festivals are usually organized with an aim for protecting and developing local culture and history, recreation, making employment opportunities and developing the local tourism industry (Günersel, 1997). Moreover, festivals also attract high-contact travelers willing to have more experiences with local people, explorers involved in the host society and allosentrics who are in the research of egotism with their cultural and educational motives.

The most important distinctive characteristic of the festivals from other events is that they are focused on society and celebration. The themes of the festivals generally arise from their own society. What is emphasized here with the society concept is a group of people having locational and operational partnership (Butcher, 1993:19), as cited in the study of , Çelik, S., & Çetinkaya, M. Y. (2013).

This study is generally aimed to explore and understand the significance and multifaceted dimensions of festival dances in the province of Capiz. This includes characterizing their history practice, occasion, processes involved, procedures, beliefs associated, settings, social function, and cultural meaning; examining their historical, aesthetic, scientific, social, socio-economic, socio-political, and spiritual aspects to provide a comprehensive overview of their impact and importance. Additionally, the study aims to identify challenges and issues related to festival dances and propose safeguarding measures to preserve and promote Capiz's cultural heritage. By documenting and analyzing these elements, the study seeks to offer insights into how festival dances contribute to the cultural richness and identity of Capiz, while also addressing the need for their continued preservation and appreciation.

(11) Materials and Methods or Methodology (This includes the materials, methods, duration & location of the study. Materials and Methods are headings used in Natural Science researches and methodology is Social Sciences. Presentation of materials may not necessarily be in separate heading but may be incorporated in the specific methods used. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

Research Design

Descriptive Approach. The research study will employ a descriptive research design to explore the festivals and its cultural significance, practices, and community involvement. This approach allows for a detailed understanding of the festivals dance in the province of Capiz.

Data Gathered

The process of acquiring data comprised of primary and secondary data from seventeen municipalities in the province of Capiz. Fieldwork and interviews with the informants were gathered from the Municipal Tourism Officers. The generated data

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from the interviews was corroborated with the secondary data on annual municipal festival programs in which the descriptions of the dances were published. Other sources were provincial-related research papers, local municipality data, official government publications, and the official Facebook page of municipal tourism in every municipality.

(12) Results and Discussions (This part contains presentation of results (data) with reference to the table and figure, to be followed by discussion, with support of reviewed literature. Sequence shall be based on the objectives of the study. Tables are formatted without the vertical lines. Horizontal lines are set at the top and bottom portions as well as below table headings and above major subdivisions. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

The first statement of the problem aimed at characterizing the history of practice, occasion/season, process involved, procedures, beliefs associated, settings, social function and cultural meaning of festival dances in the province of Capiz

The study examined the historical practices, occasion/season, process involved, procedures, beliefs associated, settings, social function and cultural meaning of seventeen municipalities, revealing a diverse range of celebrations that can be categorized into three primary themes:

Commemoration of Patron Saints and Historical Figures : Several municipalities focus their celebrations on honoring patron saints or notable individuals who have significantly impacted their history.

Pasalamat Festival in the Municipality of Dao is a deeply religious event held annually from September 20 to 22 to honor the town's patron saint, Sto. Tomas de Villanueva. Central to the festival is its theme of "Pasalamat," which means "thanksgiving," reflecting the event's primary purpose of expressing gratitude to God Almighty. As a religious fiesta, the Pasalamat Festival is characterized by its focus on spiritual devotion and communal worship. The celebration includes solemn religious ceremonies such as processions, masses, and other liturgical events dedicated to Sto. Tomas de Villanueva, which underscore the town's deep faith and reverence. This period offers an auspicious opportunity for the community to come together in collective prayer and thanksgiving for the blessings of good health, prosperity, and divine protection.

Gerard Delanty's (2003) work, *Community*, provides a comprehensive analysis of how cultural and religious festivals foster a sense of belonging and social cohesion within communities. Delanty argues that festivals are crucial in reinforcing communal ties by creating shared experiences that bridge individual and collective identities. This perspective aligns with the Pasalamat Festival's role in Dao, where communal worship and gratitude strengthen social bonds and collective faith among participants.

Sinadya sa Halaran Festival of Roxas City, Capiz, is a vibrant celebration held annually on the first weekend of December. This festival, which honors the Feast of the Virgin of the Immaculate Conception—Roxas City's patroness—blends

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both cultural and religious elements, reflecting its significance to the local community. The festival is characterized by its colorful and grand activities, including a spectacular parade and a range of cultural events. The term “Sinadya sa Halaran” translates to “Joy in Sharing and Thanksgiving,” embodying the essence of the festival as a communal expression of gratitude and celebration. The event typically spans from December 4th to 8th, showcasing both religious devotion and the vibrant spirit of the Capizeños. Through its elaborate festivities and spiritual observances, the Sinadya sa Halaran Festival reinforces Roxas City's deep religious roots and rich cultural heritage, fostering a sense of community and shared joy among its participants. Ronald H. Roberts (1999), in his article *The Role of Festivals in Social Identity Formation*, explores how festivals serve as platforms for expressing and reinforcing local identity. Roberts discusses how events like the Sinadya sa Halaran Festival in Roxas City blend religious devotion with vibrant cultural expressions, reflecting and shaping the local community's identity. This integration of cultural and religious elements highlights the festival's role in preserving and celebrating regional heritage.

Lingga Anay Festival of Panay, The Lingganay Festival, named after the Waray word for "bell," celebrates a local legend dating back to 1995. The story involves the town's golden bell, which was thrown into the Bakga River to prevent it from being taken by moro pirates. Although the bell remains lost, it is said that its sound can still be faintly heard from the river's depths. Celebrated on June 19th alongside the town's fiesta, the festival includes vibrant dance competitions, especially during the Pintados Kasadyaan Festival. This event not only showcases artistic talent but also preserves the town's folklore and traditions through performances. The festival underscores the importance of oral history in maintaining cultural heritage, ensuring that the legend and community spirit are passed down through generations, the annual feast days dedicated to patron saints and historical figures often involve elaborate parades, traditional music, and communal feasts, reflecting the deep-rooted religious and cultural values of the community. In the study of Barbara B. Bender (1985) in *The Role of Festivals in Community Formation* discusses how festivals preserve and transmit cultural heritage through oral traditions and collective performances. The Lingganay Festival in Panay, which commemorates a local legend, illustrates the festival's role in maintaining folklore and communal memory. Bender's insights highlight the importance of such festivals in ensuring that cultural narratives and traditions are passed down through generation.

According to Anthony D. Smith's research on nationalism and cultural identity suggests that commemorating significant figures and patron saints reinforces communal bonds and a shared historical narrative Smith, (1991). These celebrations provide a sense of continuity and collective memory, which are crucial for maintaining cultural identity. The ritualistic nature of these events, often tied to religious observance, fosters a sense of belonging and spiritual connection among participants. The communal aspect of these celebrations also serves to bridge generational gaps, ensuring that historical narratives and religious traditions are passed down. Moreover, the processions and ceremonies associated with these

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commemorations often attract participants from neighboring regions, enhancing inter-municipal solidarity and cultural exchange. The involvement of local authorities and religious leaders in organizing these events underscores their significance in maintaining social order and cohesion.

Cultural and Traditional Festivities: A number of municipalities celebrate their vibrant cultures and traditions. These festivals are deeply rooted in local beliefs and practices. They serve as a means to preserve and promote cultural heritage, fostering a strong sense of identity and continuity among residents.

The Pangahaw Festival of Jamindan that symbolized and significant for the Filipino Capizeño who give thanks to god who give them shower of blessings. Pangahaw derive in words “mahaw” which mean breakfast.

The Tagbuan Festival is a vibrant celebration that honors blessings and abundance within the municipality of Pilar . Held annually, this festival serves as a significant occasion for Pilareños to come together, reinforcing their shared faith, history, and cultural heritage. Central to the festival is the reenactment of traditional barter trade practices, specifically the practice known as "tagbu," which is derived from a local term meaning "to meet." This practice historically facilitated exchanges between upland farmers and lowland fishing communities, allowing them to trade agricultural products for fish and other goods. Similarly, the **Guyom-Guyoman Festival in Pontevedra**, which evolved from the Balintawak Festival started in 1988 and was renamed in 2008, emphasizes the barter trading tradition as well. The festival's name "Guyom-Guyoman" reflects the historical significance of commerce and trade in the area formerly known as Caguyoman, which translates to "anthill." This name alludes to the influx of traders and visitors from neighboring municipalities, likening their arrival to a swarm of ants gathering for commerce. Both festivals, therefore, not only celebrate their respective cultural identities but also preserve the historical practice of barter trading that has been vital to their community life. They represent a continuation of traditional practices that have long facilitated economic and social interactions among local residents..

The municipalities of **Tapaz (Patabang Festival), Sigma (Hil-o Anay Festival), Maayon,(Hil-o Hil-o Festival)and Dumarao (Padagyaw festival)** exhibit a remarkable similarity in their bayanihan attitude, especially during difficult times. This shared spirit is prominently demonstrated through the tradition of “Patabang” or “bayanihan”, a practice where community members come together to support one another in times of need. This tradition not only fosters a deep sense of solidarity and mutual aid but also acts as a cohesive force that unites these municipalities. By embracing this communal approach to overcoming challenges, they strengthen their collective pursuit of advancement and success, ensuring that their shared values of cooperation and resilience are upheld as they navigate both hardships and opportunities.

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The **Agdahanay Festival of Cuartero** is a week-long celebration designed to honor the town's spiritual and cultural heritage. Derived from the term "Agdahanay," meaning "inviting and accommodating others," the festival emphasizes community spirit and hospitality. Throughout the week, Cuartereños participate in a range of activities, including vibrant street dancing, cultural performances, and various festive events. These activities not only offer enjoyment but also reinforce the town's cultural identity and collective ethos. By blending traditional practices with modern festivities, the Agdahanay Festival showcases Cuartero's deep-rooted spiritual values and cultural pride, fostering communal unity and preserving local traditions.

The **festival of Ivisan is Buyloganay**, celebrated every September 10 in Ivisan, honors St. Nicholas of Tolentino, the town's patron saint. This festival epitomizes the local culture characterized by unity and cooperation. Historically, it involves various communal activities that bring the community together, reinforcing shared beliefs and social cohesion. The festival includes communal feasts, dances, and other traditional activities that showcase the town's rich heritage. The setting within Ivisan underscores the festival's local significance, fostering a strong sense of identity and continuity among residents. Buyloganay is not only a religious observance but also a celebration of communal harmony and cultural heritage. It serves as a vital reminder of the importance of community spirit and collective effort in maintaining cultural traditions. Through this annual celebration, the people of Ivisan express their gratitude, strengthen social bonds, and ensure that their cultural practices are passed down to future generations, preserving their unique identity.

The Inilusan Festival of Mambusao, first introduced in 1975, is a vibrant celebration held on November 25 in honor of Saint Catherine of Alexandria. This festival is notable for its colorful pageantry, which recounts the town's historical and cultural evolution while emphasizing the values of mutual generosity and community spirit. The term "Inilusan" signifies the mutual and generous sharing of food and resources, reflecting the fraternal goodwill that is integral to Mambusao's daily life. The festival plays a crucial role in reinforcing communal values and enhancing social cohesion by showcasing the town's shared heritage and collective identity. Hernandez (2014) discusses how festivals like Inilusan preserve and celebrate local historical and cultural heritage in "Local Festivals and Cultural Heritage: The Case of Mambusao," while Montemayor (2018) explores the role of community festivals in strengthening social bonds in "Community Festivals and Social Cohesion." .

The **Pagpasidungog Festival in Panitan** is a significant event dedicated to honoring individuals who have made substantial contributions to the town's social, cultural, educational, and economic development. Held annually, this festival serves not only to recognize and celebrate the achievements of prominent Paniteños but also to inspire and motivate the younger generation. By highlighting local heroes and their contributions, the festival reinforces the value of personal and communal achievements in the context of societal progress. This emphasis on recognition and celebration of local success is explored by Ramos (2016) in "Honoring Local Heroes: The Role of Festivals in Community Recognition," and further examined by

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Diaz (2019) in "Cultural Festivals and Social Capital," which discusses how such festivals contribute to building social capital and fostering community cohesion.

Victor Turner's concept of social dramas and rituals highlights how cultural festivals act as communal rites of passage, strengthening social ties and reinforcing cultural norms. These events are not only a celebration of the past but also a dynamic process of cultural transmission and adaptation. They provide a platform for the expression of local identities and the reinforcement of cultural boundaries. The vibrant displays of traditional music, dance, and attire during these festivals serve as a form of resistance against cultural homogenization, asserting the uniqueness of local cultures. Furthermore, these celebrations often involve participatory activities that engage various segments of the community, including youth, thereby ensuring the continuity of cultural practices. The economic impact of these festivals, through tourism and local crafts, also highlights their role in community sustainability and development. (Turner, 1969).

Livelihood-Centric Celebrations: Some municipalities emphasize their rich livelihoods, particularly focusing on coastal or agricultural aspects. These celebrations showcase the economic and environmental significance of these activities through fairs, exhibitions, and demonstrations. They highlight the community's connection to their natural resources and the vital role of these industries in their daily lives.

Sapian traditionally celebrates the **Tilibyugan sa Talahong** Festival from July 21 to 26 each year. This long-standing festival is distinguished by its dedication to preserving cultural practices and honoring Saint Anne, the town's Patron Saint. In contrast, the Talahong Festival was conceived as a major initiative with entrepreneurial and tourism goals to stimulate the town's economic development. Held annually on the 2nd Friday and Saturday of May, the Talahong Festival is categorized as a coastal livelihood festival. It emphasizes seafood products such as "talaba" and "tahong" and integrates arts and culture to promote Sapian while supporting local fisherfolks, travel operators, and the local government. Sapian, a coastal town in Capiz, is known for its rich production of seafood, particularly in Sapian Bay, which encompasses nine of its ten barangays. The Local Government Unit's initiative to organize the Talahong Festival reflects the town's abundant seafood resources and aims to showcase these products at their best. In contrast, **the Hil-o Hil-o Festival in Maayon**, celebrated during the 3rd week of February, falls under the category of agricultural livelihood festivals. It focuses on community cooperation and reciprocity within the agricultural sector. This festival represents the tradition of mutual assistance and support in agricultural activities, expressed through various forms of help and contributions to important family events. It highlights the values of cooperation and interdependence within the agricultural community. Similarly, **the Ilig Festival in Dumalag**, which means "downstream or seaward travel," also falls under the agricultural livelihood festival category. It

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commemorates the historical practice of transporting bamboo via rafts along Panay River. This festival pays tribute to bamboo—a vital resource for the local community—while reflecting the enduring spirit of the Dumalagnons. It holds religious significance, symbolizing the journey towards spiritual fulfillment and the need for strong faith and charitable actions. Key activities include street dancing (Sadsad-Hapayhapay), communal efforts (Tangkores), a bamboo trade fair (Kabutungan), a fluvial parade (Biray-Lantay), and other events highlighting the importance of bamboo. The festival concludes on the 2nd Saturday after Easter, coinciding with the Feast of Mary, Our Lady of Consolation, the secondary patroness of Dumalag. The historical practices and celebrations of these municipalities are integral to their communal identity and cohesion. The diversity in celebratory themes reflects the multifaceted nature of local histories, beliefs, and livelihoods.

Eric Hobsbawm's theory on the invention of tradition posits that many community practices are constructed to serve contemporary needs and identities (Hobsbawm, 1983). Celebrations centered around livelihoods, whether agricultural or coastal, demonstrate how communities adapt traditional practices to sustain their economic and environmental realities.

These festivals often incorporate modern elements to address current socio-economic challenges, such as promoting sustainable practices or highlighting the importance of local industries in the face of globalization. The agricultural and coastal celebrations provide an opportunity for knowledge exchange and innovation, as local farmers and fishermen share techniques and best practices. These events also foster a sense of pride and stewardship over local resources, promoting environmental conservation. The communal participation in such festivals underscores the interconnectedness of community members and their collective responsibility towards sustaining their livelihood.

The second statement of the problem aimed at determining the significance of festival in terms of its historical, aesthetic, scientific, social , social economic, socio-political and spiritual.

In the province of Capiz, festival dances serve as a dynamic expression of cultural heritage, reflecting the unique identity of its seventeen municipalities. These vibrant performances encompass a wide array of historical, aesthetic, social, socio-economic, socio-political, and spiritual significances. aims to delve into the multifaceted impact of these festival dances.

Historical Significance

Festival dances are crucial in preserving and transmitting the authentic traditions and culture of local communities. These festival dances encapsulate the rich history of each municipality, reflecting their heritage through choreographed movements, traditional attire, and symbolic acts. The data shows that the seventeen

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municipalities in the province of Capiz are dedicated to preserving the unique history of each municipality, making sure that the younger generations have the opportunity to explore and observe as they pass this on to the next generations. This finding is supported by the research conducted by Kirshenblatt-Gimblett (1998), cultural performances act as living museums, ensuring that stories, rituals, and customs are passed down through generations. Hobsbawm and Ranger (1983) further highlight how traditions, often seen in festivals, are consciously revived or created to serve modern needs, emphasizing the dynamic nature of cultural heritage. Such festivals serve as a repository of collective memory, where the community's historical consciousness is both preserved and continuously reinterpreted. This historical dimension also reinforces social cohesion by reminding community members of their shared past, as discussed by Eric Hobsbawm (1992), where he explores the role of invented traditions in fostering national identity. Furthermore, Maurice Halbwachs' (2015) concept of collective memory suggests that festival dances provide a framework for remembering and interpreting the past within the context of contemporary culture, thus maintaining a continuous link to the past and fostering a deep sense of identity and continuity among younger generations.

Aesthetic Significance

The data reveals that the seventeen municipalities in the province of Capiz exhibit visually striking festival dances, distinguished by their vibrant performances, colorful traditional attire, and aesthetically crafted decorations. The aesthetic dimension of these dances underscores the rich artistic heritage of Capiz's municipalities. Characterized by elaborate costumes, dynamic movements, and intricate choreography, each performance is carefully designed to reflect the unique cultural expressions of the community. Collectively, these elements create a festive atmosphere that enhances sensory experiences and celebrates local artistic traditions. This finding is supported by the study of Storey (2018) highlights how visual and performing arts enhance cultural pride and contribute to the appreciation of a community's identity. The colorful and often handcrafted costumes adorned with traditional motifs are not just visually captivating but also symbolize various aspects of local culture and history. Berleant (1991) emphasizes the participatory nature of aesthetic experiences, which engage both performers and audiences in a shared cultural and artistic expression. Furthermore, Schechner's (1962) work on performance studies elucidates how these artistic displays convey complex cultural narratives, making festival dances a powerful medium for both entertainment and education.

Social Significance

The data reveals that the social significance of the festivals across the seventeen municipalities in Capiz plays a pivotal role in enhancing community cohesion. These festivals create opportunities for locals, families, friends, and neighbors to gather and engage in shared celebrations, fostering a sense of unity and collective identity. By bringing together diverse segments of the community, these events strengthen interpersonal connections and reinforce social bonds, facilitating a collaborative and

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harmonious atmosphere. The communal activities associated with these festivals not only celebrate local traditions but also contribute to the overall social fabric by encouraging interaction and mutual support among locals. This finding supported by the study conducted by Turner's (1969) concept of "communitas" describes how such collective rituals create a shared sense of belonging and strengthen social bonds. These festivals offer opportunities for individuals to come together, share experiences, and build relationships, thereby nurturing a sense of unity and inclusion. Putnam (2000) discusses the role of community activities in rebuilding social capital and fostering civic engagement, highlighting how festivals act as social bridges that connect individuals from diverse backgrounds. Bourdieu's (1986) notion of social capital further explains how these communal gatherings enhance mutual understanding and bridge social gaps. Michel Maffesoli's (1996) exploration of modern sociality emphasizes how festivals create temporary yet powerful communal bonds that transcend everyday social divisions, reinforcing the social fabric of the community.

Socio-Economic Significance

The data shows that festivals in all seventeen municipalities greatly benefit the local economy by attracting visitors and encouraging everyone to support local products of their municipality. These events provide a valuable opportunity to locals business to showcase their local products and increase their sales. This finding supported by the study of Richards in 2007 that examines the economic benefits of cultural tourism, noting how festivals provide opportunities for local businesses and artisans. The UNWTO Global Report on Cultural Tourism (2018) supports this, detailing how cultural festivals drive economic development and support local economies. Festival dances generate significant revenue through tourism, as visitors spend on accommodations, food, transportation, and souvenirs, creating a ripple effect that benefits the entire community. Michael Porter's (1990) theories on competitive advantage suggest that these festivals enhance regional visibility and attractiveness, encouraging further investment and economic growth. Jane Jacobs (1969) also discusses how vibrant cultural activities contribute to urban renewal and economic diversification, underscoring the role of festivals in stimulating local economies and promoting sustainable development.

Socio-Political Significance

Festival dances of every municipality serve as powerful platforms for expressing community identities and engaging in socio-political discourse. These events provide a space for local communities to assert their cultural and political presence, fostering civic pride and participation. Appiah (2006) argues that cultural festivals enable communities to express their identity, celebrate their heritage, and engage in social and political dialogue. Anderson (1983) explores how cultural symbols and rituals contribute to the construction and reinforcement of collective identities and national consciousness. Habermas's (1989) theory of the public sphere posits that festivals provide a forum for public

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discussion, enabling citizens to voice their concerns and advocate for social change. Clifford Geertz's (1973) concept of "thick description" allows for a deep analysis of cultural performances, revealing the intricate dynamics of power and identity within communities. By promoting civic engagement and cultural pride, festival dances strengthen the socio-political fabric of the municipality.

Spiritual Significance

The findings shows that the seventeen municipalities are deeply connected to religious traditions and spiritual values. They not only celebrate patron saints or historical figures but also It provides opportunities for acts of charity, compassion, and community service, reflecting spiritual values of kindness. This finding supported by the study of Durkheim's (1912) exploration of religious rituals highlights how festivals reinforce collective beliefs and strengthen the moral fabric of communities. Eliade (1957) discusses how religious rituals and festivals create a sense of the sacred, bringing communities together in shared spiritual experiences. Smart's (1998) dimensions of religion framework provides insights into how these spiritual elements foster a shared sense of spirituality and collective identity. Victor and Edith Turner's (1978) work on pilgrimage explores how religious festivals serve as communal rites of passage, fostering a collective sense of renewal and spiritual reinvigoration. By integrating spiritual practices into cultural celebrations, festival dances contribute to the overall well-being and cohesion of the community, reinforcing moral values and promoting social harmony.

The third statement of the problem aimed at identifying the issues and challenges faced by local communities in Capiz in conserving and preserving their festivals.

In municipalities like Dao, Ivisan, Dumarao, and Sigma, the primary challenge is financial constraints. Limited budgets hinder the ability to fund necessary activities and infrastructure for festival preservation. This situation aligns with research by Mair and Whitford (2013), who found that financial limitations often prevent effective festival management and preservation. Without adequate financial resources and support from local government units (LGUs), maintaining the traditional aspects of these festivals and ensuring their continuity becomes increasingly difficult.

Additionally, environmental factors such as adverse weather conditions present significant challenges in municipalities like Pontevedra and Cuartero. Unpredictable or damaging weather can disrupt festival activities and damage crucial elements of the celebrations, leading to logistical problems and a diminished overall festival experience. This is consistent with Aitchison's (2003) research, which highlights how weather conditions can affect festival logistics and the quality of the event. Political issues also play a crucial role in festival preservation. In some areas, political instability or shifts in local government priorities can result in inconsistent support or funding for festivals, impacting their preservation and continuity. This observation mirrors Smith's (2009) findings on how political instability and shifting priorities can disrupt support for cultural events.

In Panit-an and Jamindan, the challenge is related to the misinterpretation of cultural heritage and its transmission to future generations. Misunderstandings or

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incorrect interpretations of the festival's history and cultural significance can undermine its preservation and continuation. This issue is supported by Hooper's (1998) research, which discusses how misinterpretation of cultural heritage can affect its transmission.

Modernization poses another challenge in Dumalag, where traditional practices face the risk of dilution due to modernization. Research by Taylor and Davis (2012) indicates that modernization can often lead to the erosion of traditional cultural practices, impacting the authenticity of festivals and other cultural events. In the municipality of Sapián, challenges include a lack of support and cooperation from local officials and insufficient local awareness about the importance of the festival. Richards (2015) highlights how local support and awareness are crucial for successful festival conservation efforts, underscoring the impact of these factors on the preservation process.

On the other hand, municipalities like Mambusao demonstrate fewer challenges in festival preservation. These areas benefit from stable financial support, favorable weather conditions, and a supportive political environment, which collectively contribute to more successful conservation and transmission of cultural traditions. This aligns with the findings that a supportive environment facilitates effective festival preservation and cultural transmission.

The fourth statement of the problem aimed to determine the safeguarding measures taken by local municipalities to preserve and conserve their festivals.

The findings highlight the diverse strategies employed across different municipalities in Capiz to ensure the continuity and vibrancy of their cultural celebrations.

The study reveals that municipalities in Capiz employ a range of strategies to safeguard their cultural festivals. The municipality of Mambusao, along with Roxas City, Panay, Tapaz, Panitan, and President Roxas, uses a combination of formal and non-formal education, documentation, preservation, and promotion. While the municipality of Ivisan, Sapián, Dumalag, and Maayon focus on non-formal education, documentation, preservation, and promotion. Pilar, Jamindan, and Dao integrate non-formal education with documentation, preservation, promotion, and revitalization. Pontevedra and Sigma emphasize community-based non-formal education along with preservation and promotion, while Dumarao and Cuartero adopt a comprehensive approach that includes both formal and non-formal education, documentation, preservation, promotion, and revitalization.

(13) Conclusions and Recommendations (This part shall be written in narrative form and arranged based on the objectives and findings. Conclusions are general statements answering the objectives. Recommendations are based on the conclusions. They may be split or combined based on their length, which means, conclusions and recommendations may be split under separate headings if they are long. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

CONCLUSIONS

Based on the results of the study, the following conclusions were drawn:

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1. In terms of history of practice, occasion/season, process involved, procedures, beliefs associated, settings, social function, and cultural meaning. The study reveals that festivals are rich, dynamic events characterized by their historical practices, seasonal or occasional timing, and intricate processes. Each festival is deeply rooted in historical traditions that shape its current form and significance. The timing and occasion of festivals often reflect agricultural cycles, religious calendars, or historical anniversaries, aligning them with natural or societal rhythms. The processes and procedures involved in festivals are diverse, including preparation rituals, ceremonial activities, and communal participation, all of which contribute to their unique character and execution. The beliefs associated with festivals are integral, often encapsulating religious, spiritual, or cultural values that drive the festival's purpose and activities. Festivals are set in various contexts, from urban spaces to rural settings, which influence their scope and impact. Socially, they serve as platforms for community bonding, socialization, and collective identity. Culturally, festivals carry profound meanings, encapsulating and celebrating the essence of cultural heritage, values, and traditions.
2. In terms of significance of historical, aesthetic, social, social economic, socio-political, and spiritual. This study highlights that festivals are integral to human societies, serving multiple roles. Historically, they preserve cultural heritage and reflect civilization's evolution. Aesthetically, they showcase artistic expression. Socially and economically, festivals strengthen community bonds and boost local economies. Politically, they facilitate civic engagement, and spiritually, they offer moments of reflection and connection to cultural values.
3. The challenges and issues encountered by the locals include financial constraints, weather conditions, and issues with awareness and literature interpretation. Limited budgets often hinder the preservation and conservation of festivals, impacting their sustainability and quality. Weather-related disruptions can affect the scheduling and execution of events, posing additional logistical difficulties. Moreover, a lack of awareness and inadequate interpretation of festival literature hinder the transmission of cultural knowledge to future generations.
4. In terms of safeguarding measures taken by the locals, they employ a range of safeguarding measures to preserve and conserve festivals. Key strategies include formal and non-formal education to transmit festival knowledge, identification and documentation of festival practices, and ongoing research to deepen understanding. Efforts also encompass the preservation and protection of cultural elements, along with promotion and enhancement activities to raise awareness. Revitalization initiatives help to keep festivals vibrant and relevant. These comprehensive measures collectively support the sustainability and continuity of festivals in resident municipalities.

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RECOMMENDATIONS

Based from the findings of the study, the following are recommended :

1. It is recommended to thoroughly document the historical practices of festival dances to preserve their authenticity. Standardizing procedures and maintaining detailed records will help ensure consistent presentation and execution. Preserving associated beliefs and settings is crucial for maintaining cultural integrity. Additionally, efforts should be made to enhance the social and cultural functions of these dances by promoting their role in community bonding and cultural expression.
2. To maximize the impact of festivals, it is recommended to leverage historical insights in terms of cultural interpretation to guide their development and preservation, ensuring that they reflect their historical roots. Supporting artistic contributions will enrich festival presentations and foster innovation. Strengthening the social and economic benefits of festivals through improved management and community engagement is essential. Furthermore, addressing the socio-political and spiritual dimensions of festivals will enhance their relevance and impact in the municipalities in the province of Capiz .
3. To effectively tackle the challenges faced by festivals, it is recommended to secure diverse sources of funding to ensure financial stability and sustainability. Developing comprehensive weather contingency plans in case of a weather disturbance and mitigating disruptions to festival celebrations in their municipalities.
4. Enhancing public awareness through extension programs will improve understanding and support for festivals, thereby addressing issues related to visibility and community involvement.
5. Further research is needed in terms of the lived experiences of cultural workers like choreographers , dancers, instrumentalists, script writers, and locals.

(14) Output (Indicate the specific products, processes or services which the project has produced; quantify when possible.)

(15) Technology Transfer Activity Conducted (Indicate the specific products, activity design, processes or services transferred as extension activities)

(16) Economic Analysis (This should present the direct cost of project implementation, expenses in the production of technology, revenues generated from technology produced, return on investment (ROI) and payback period.

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(17) Acknowledgments (Include only important persons and institutions with involvement in funding and conduct of the research. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

The researcher would like to acknowledge with heartfelt gratitude the following individuals who have been instrumental in the completion and success of this study;

Dr. Efren L. Linan , VP for RDE, for his sincere guidance, wholehearted support, priceless assistance, constant advice, and perseverance from the preparation of the research .

Dr. Leo Andrew B. Bicular , Research Director, for giving his valuable comments and recommendations, suggestions, constant reminders towards the completion of the study;

Dr. Gerard Lee Atienza ,COE Research Coordinator , for his valuable support, suggestions, recommendations, and time in editing the manuscript.

Mr.Francis N. Singson , Research Assistant, for his time and effort for the accomplishment of the study.

(18) References (It should include only works mentioned in the text and should be arranged alphabetically. Citations shall not be less than 13 entries. This must follow the APA latest edition format, in hanging indention with 12-point space in between.)

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